

STS. PETER AND PAUL: THE APOSTLES WHO BUILT THE CHURCH

SESSION 00.10 HANDOUT

NAME _____ DATE _____

♦ MEMORY VERSE — COPY BY HAND

These are the words of Christ to Peter when Peter confessed Him as the Son of the Living God. The Church Nolan walks into at SJTD this Sunday begins, in some sense, with this sentence. Copy the verse below twice in your best handwriting.

Thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build My Church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it. — Matthew 16:18

♦ VOCABULARY — MATCH EACH WORD TO ITS MEANING

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

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| APOSTLE | • | • | <i>Petros</i> in Greek, <i>Cephas</i> in Aramaic. The new name Christ gave Simon the fisherman — <i>the one on whom the Church is built</i> . |
| PILLAR | • | • | The road on which the risen Christ appeared to Saul, knocking him to the ground and changing him forever. |
| ROCK | • | • | Greek for <i>one who is sent</i> . The twelve men Christ chose, sent out into all the world to preach the Gospel and build the Church. |
| DAMASCUS ROAD | • | • | A title for Peter and Paul together — the <i>two pillars</i> of the Orthodox Church. Their feast is June 29. |

♦ TIMELINE — THE LIVES OF PETER AND PAUL

Use the word bank to fill in each blank. **Word bank:** ~33 AD · ~33 AD (around the same time) · ~67 AD · ~67 AD (around the same year)

APPROXIMATE DATE	WHAT HAPPENED
_____	Christ calls Simon the fisherman to follow Him and renames him Peter — the Rock.
_____	Saul of Tarsus persecutes the early Church; on the road to Damascus, the risen Christ knocks him to the ground. He is baptized, renamed Paul, and sent.
_____	Peter is crucified upside-down in Rome (he said he was not worthy to die the same way Christ did).
_____	Paul is beheaded in Rome — the same city, around the same year. Their feast on June 29 honors them together.

✦ SKETCH — THEIR ICONS AT SJTD

Most Orthodox iconostases include Peter and Paul somewhere prominent in the nave. Draw simple versions of their icons in the boxes below. Look for them this Sunday at SJTD.

ST. PETER — THE ROCK



Peter holds **keys** — the keys of the Kingdom, given by Christ in Matthew 16.

ST. PAUL — THE APOSTLE TO THE GENTILES



Paul holds a **sword** (martyrdom + the sword of the Spirit) and a **scroll** or **book** (his letters in your Bible).

✦ REFLECTION — WRITE 3 TO 5 SENTENCES

Peter denied Christ three times. Paul personally hunted down Christians and approved their killings. Both became the greatest Apostles of the Church. The lesson said: *failure does not disqualify*. Write 3 to 5 sentences. Have you ever felt that something you did wrong should disqualify you from being loved? What do Peter and Paul say back to that fear? *It's okay to write that you have felt that. It's okay to keep your answer short. The two pillars are listening.*
